RoboPIN: Grounded Embodied Reasoning via Pinned Chain-of-Thought

Yaoting Huang* · Yifu Yuan*† · Linqi Han · Chengwen Li
Shuoheng Zhang · Xianze Yao · Hongyao Tang · Yan Zheng · Jianye Hao†

Tianjin University · ACM Multimedia 2026 · Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

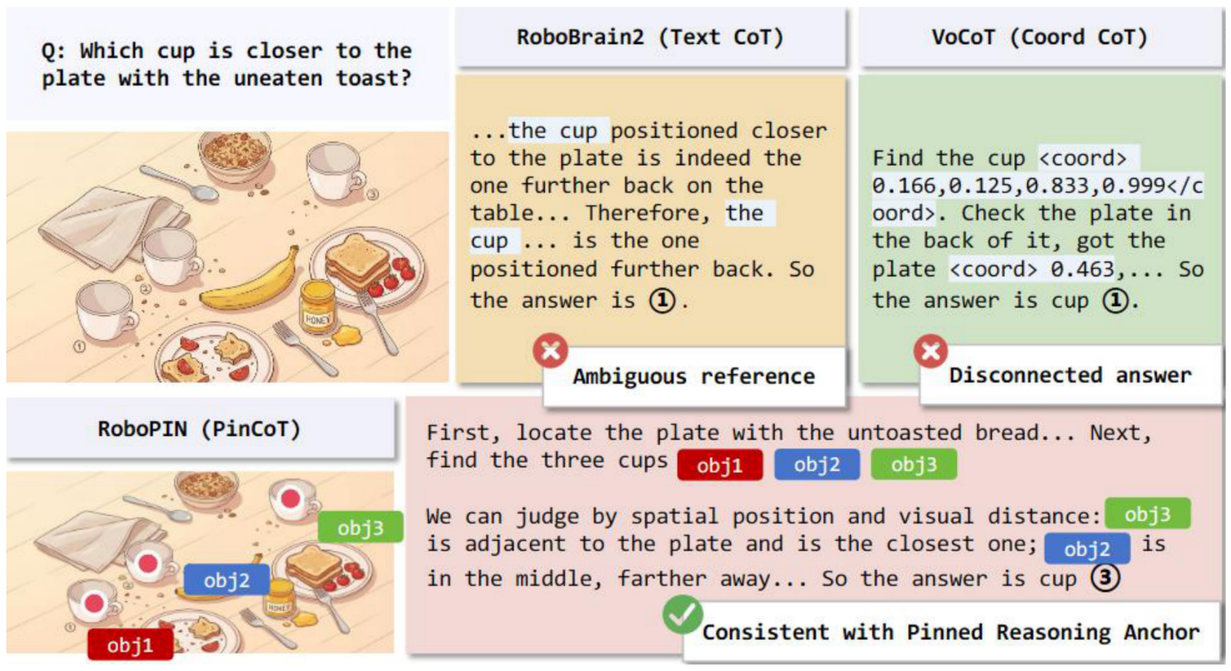
quark404@tju.edu.cn · yuanyf@tju.edu.cn

* Equal contribution † Corresponding authors

Tianjin University

ACM Multimedia 2026
Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

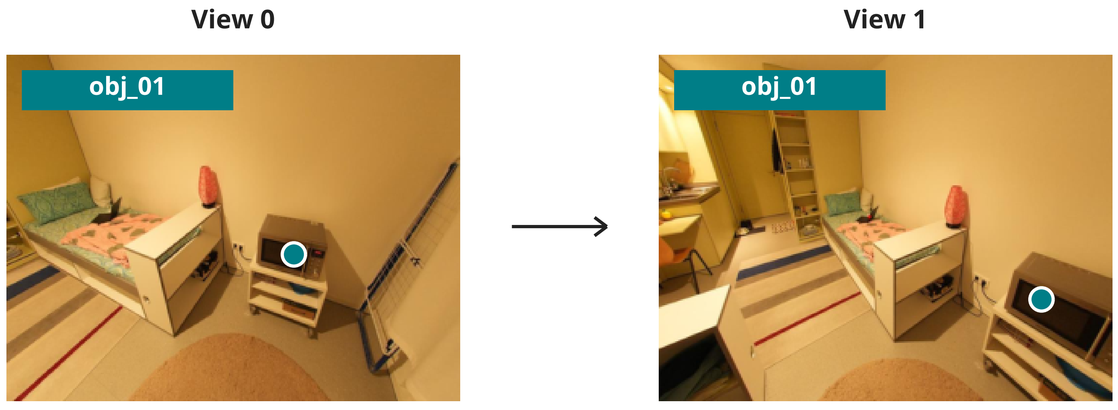
Motivation



1. Text-based references can drift between similar objects. Coordinate-only grounding lacks explicit identity tracking.

2. A model may correctly analyze object A, then silently point to object B. This reasoning-to-answer misalignment breaks reliable visual grounding.

Key Insight: Persistent Identity

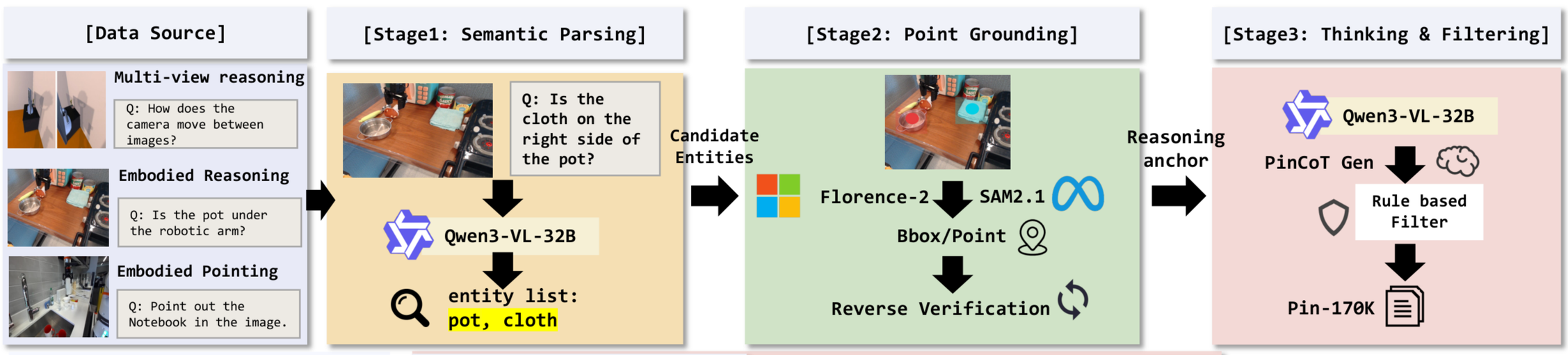


From isolated grounding to persistent anchors

- **Spatial references are usually isolated annotations, without explicit identity tracking during reasoning.**
- **PinCoT binds each entity to a name, ID, view and point. Later steps reuse the same ID.**
- **Our insight: visual anchors act as persistent reasoning variables, making each step traceable to visual evidence.**

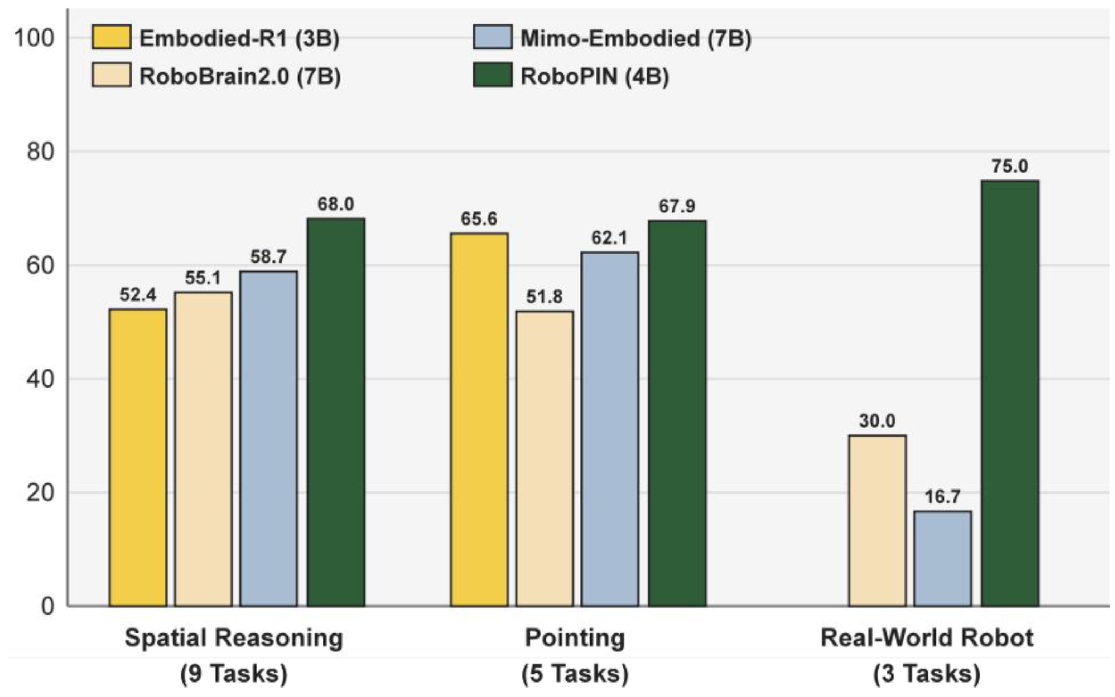
QR PLACEHOLDER
PAPER / CODE

Our Method: RoboPIN / PinCoT

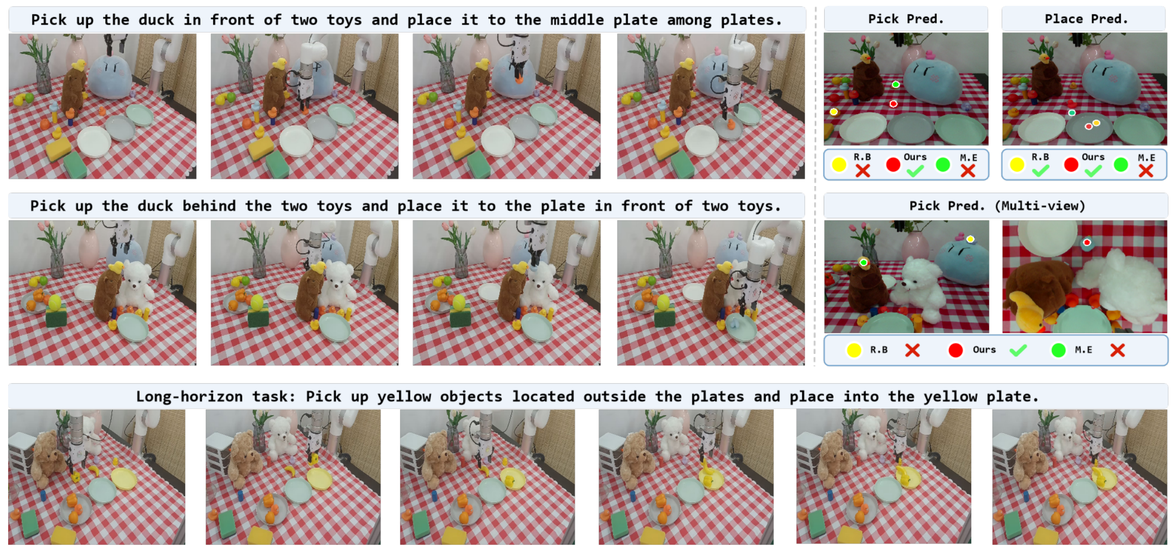


We propose PinCoT, which pins every reasoning step to visual evidence through persistent identity-aware anchors.
RoboPIN learns this representation through SFT, CoT-SFT and process-supervised RFT / GRPO.

Experimental Results

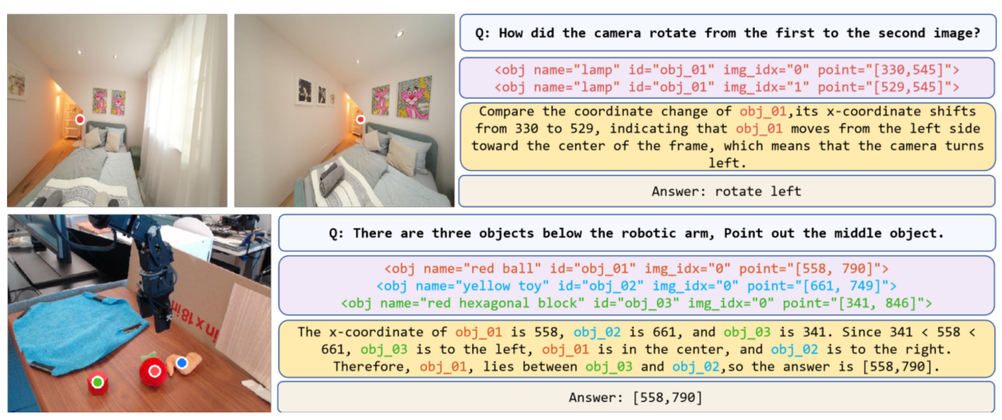


Qualitative Results



Zero-shot xArm · successes / 20

20 / 20	14 / 20	11 / 20
Spatial	Multi-view	Long-horizon



Ablation studies

Reward design

Setting	EmbSpatial
Full reward	**84.7**
w/o Pin	82.0
w/o Consistency	82.7

Training stages

Stage	Spatial	Point
SFT	57.0	66.0
+ CoT-SFT	62.0	63.6
+ RFT	**67.7**	**67.9**

Spatial reasoning: +10.7 points from SFT to RFT.

Persistent Visual Anchors · Consistent Reasoning · Grounded Answers